

BizSim — Business Plan

Multi-tenant SaaS for entrepreneurship programs. Training → exams → simulation → hackathon judging → certification, in one white-label platform.

Stage	Working product, pre-revenue. 29 data models, 40 API routes, 126 tests (~90% core coverage), clean production build.
Raise	Seed — \$750K (range \$500K-\$1M)
Runway	24 months to ~\$330K ARR and Series A readiness
Beachhead	Turkey (113 technoparks, 208 universities) + Azerbaijan (51 HEIs, IDDA) → EU/Gulf/Central Asia
Model	Per-seat annual licence, \$22-\$29/seat + platform fee. Blended ACV \$7K → \$14K

1. Executive Summary

What it is. BizSim digitises the full lifecycle of an entrepreneurship program. An institution licenses seats, runs its own programs under its own brand, and BizSim never touches its content — enforced in code by a 5-role RBAC matrix and PostgreSQL row-level security.

Why now.

- Institutions buying today assemble 3-4 tools: an LMS (Moodle/Canvas), a per-student simulation (\$30-\$50/student), a judging tool (Award Force \$3,250-\$6,500/yr), and a spreadsheet. Nothing joins them.
- Funding is flowing to exactly this buyer: **EIT HEI Initiative — €70M call for 2026-2028**, up to €2M per project, explicitly for "entrepreneurship training and startup support" in HEIs. Horizon Europe's European Innovation Ecosystems cluster adds **€65.1M for 2026-27**.
- Turkey's technopark base grew to **113 zones, 12,188 resident companies, 125,124 employees** — a dense, funded, underserved buyer set 2 hours from Baku.

Traction to date. Product, not revenue. Working end-to-end: video training with per-lesson progress, server-side graded exams, hackathon/jury system (team formation, PDF submission, weighted criteria, live leaderboard, scheduled results reveal with email), QR-code participant onboarding, gamification, certificates, audit logging, 2FA, Stripe/Payriff/Iyzico integrations, Docker + Terraform + CI/CD.

What the money buys. Convert a built product into a sold product: 6 → 35 paying institutions, close the three functional gaps (simulation gameplay, AI tooling, live deployment), and prove per-seat economics at \$9K ACV with a 13-month CAC payback.

Key figures (base case):

	2026*	2027	2028	2029	2030
Institutions	7	35	100	215	374
ARR	\$49K	\$327K	\$1.10M	\$2.69M	\$5.28M
Revenue	\$7K	\$188K	\$719K	\$1.91M	\$4.00M
EBITDA	-\$105K	-\$497K	-\$553K	-\$222K	+\$773K
FTE	6.5	13	22	34	47

* 2026 is a Q4 stub year from seed close. Cumulative burn through 2027 = **\$602K**, inside the \$750K raise. Series A (~\$3M) targeted H1 2028 to fund the 2028-29 scale-up.

2. Problem & Solution

The problem, by buyer

Buyer	What they run today	What breaks
Technopark / incubator	Excel + email + printed jury sheets	No participant history, no defensible scoring, impact reports rebuilt by hand each cycle
University e-ship centre	Campus LMS (no competition layer) + a bought simulation + an event microsite	Three logins, three gradebooks, nothing rolls up into one record
Accelerator	Application tool (F6S/YouNoodle) + Google Forms for judging	Judging starts at submission — the platform knows nothing about what the cohort learned
Government innovation agency	Bespoke build per program	Cost per program never amortises; no cross-program comparison

The sharp pain — hackathon judging. It is subjective and unauditable: who scored what, against which criterion, at what weight, is not recorded. Institutions defend results they cannot reconstruct. This is why judging is sold as its own product category — and why it is the wedge.

The solution

One platform, one participant record, one gradebook:

Layer	What BizSim does	Status
Onboard	QR code / apply-token registration; atomic seat licensing (<code>SELECT FOR UPDATE</code> , no overselling)	✓ Live
Teach	Video courses, per-lesson progress tracking, playlists	✓ Live
Test	Server-side graded exams — correct answers never reach the browser; best-attempt scoring	✓ Live
Simulate	Decision-based business simulations with tasks tied to coins/badges	⚠ Data model built, gameplay UI incomplete
Compete	Teams (max 5), PDF submission (10MB, magic-byte validated, versioned), weighted jury criteria, live leaderboard, scheduled reveal with countdown + email	✓ Live
Coach	7 AI tools (mentor, pitch coach, jury assistant, evaluation)	⚠ Endpoint built, integrations incomplete
Certify	Participation / achievement / completion certificates	⚠ Issuance live, PDF pipeline missing
Prove	Central audit log, business metrics, report export queue	✓ Live

The architectural bet — hard multi-tenancy. Every institution runs under its own brand with `tenantId` isolation on every core model plus PostgreSQL RLS. The platform owner provisions the account and hands over the keys; program, jury and hackathon control sit entirely with the tenant. Permissions removed from the super-admin role are locked by a failing test if anyone re-adds them. This is what lets one codebase serve a university, a technopark and a ministry without forking.

3. Market Size

Bottom-up TAM

Layer	Build	Value
TAM	264M tertiary students worldwide (UNESCO, 2025); ~20% in business/administration/entrepreneurship-adjacent programs = ~53M seats × \$25/seat + ~22,700 institutions × ~\$4K platform fee	≈ \$1.4B / yr
SAM	EU + UK + Turkey + Caucasus + Central Asia + Gulf: ~4,200 HEIs and ~700 parks/incubators/agencies; ~9M addressable seats. EN/TR/AZ UI already ships	≈ \$240M / yr
SOM	374 institutions by 2030 at \$14.1K blended ACV	\$5.3M ARR = 2.2% of SAM

Beachhead (immediate, verified): Turkey — 113 technoparks (94 active) and 208 universities with 6.3M students; Azerbaijan — 51 HEIs, IDDA with 750+ startups supported. **372 institutions × \$12K = \$4.5M** addressable without leaving the region.

Top-down cross-check

Adjacent market	2025/26 size	CAGR	Source
Higher-education LMS	\$35.8B (2025)	21.6%	MarketsandMarkets
Simulation learning	\$29.2B (2026)	16.4%	The Business Research Company
Game-based learning	\$6.2B (2025)	23.4%	MarketsandMarkets
Hackathon management software	\$1.37B (2026)	12.6%	Business Research Insights

TAM at \$1.4B is ~2% of these pools combined — the estimate is conservative by construction.

Headwind to state plainly: EdTech venture funding hit **\$1.8B in 2024, the lowest since 2014** (HolonIQ). The market is being funded on unit economics, not narrative. That shapes the plan below.

4. Monetization Model

Pricing

Current in-product tiers are seat-only (\$29 / \$25 / \$22 by volume). **Recommended change: platform fee + seats.** A pure seat price of \$22–\$29 is *below* what institutions already pay for a single simulation licence (\$30–\$50/student at Interpretive and HBP) — the platform is underpriced, and a seat-only model gives no floor when a cohort is small.

Plan	Target buyer	Seats incl.	Platform fee	Seat overage	
Starter	University e-ship centre, single program	100	\$2,100	\$29	\$5,000
Growth	Technopark, accelerator, faculty-wide	250	\$5,750	\$25	\$12,000
Enterprise	Gov agency, multi-campus system	1,000	\$13,000	\$22	\$35,000

Add-ons: white-label domain, SSO, AI tool pack, custom simulation authoring, hosted hackathon operations.

Revenue streams

Stream	2027 mix	Notes
Seat licences (annual, prepaid)	~54%	Scales with cohort size; the expansion lever
Platform fees	~41%	Revenue floor independent of cohort size — this is what fixes the underpricing
Services (onboarding, custom sim, hackathon ops)	~5%	Deliberately capped — keeps gross margin $\geq 85\%$

At 35 institutions the mix is \$177K seats + \$135K platform fees. Platform fees are what make a 40-seat pilot worth selling.

Unit economics

	2027	2028	2029	2030
Blended ACV	\$9,375	\$11,038	\$12,548	\$14,140
CAC	\$9,000	\$8,000	\$7,200	\$6,500
CAC payback	13.6 mo	10.2 mo	8.1 mo	6.5 mo
LTV (4-yr, 85% GM)	\$31.9K	\$37.5K	\$42.7K	\$48.1K
LTV:CAC	3.5x	4.7x	5.9x	7.4x

Benchmarks for context: education-industry CAC averages \$1,143 blended but govtech carries a **2.5-4.0x multiplier** and higher-ed sales cycles run **9-18 months** (12-24 for system-level RFPs). Vertical SaaS median NRR is **118%**; the model assumes **112%** net expansion — deliberately below benchmark.

Churn assumptions: Starter 18%, Growth 10%, Enterprise 5%. Higher than typical vertical SaaS, because a single-program university buyer can lapse when a champion leaves.

Why CAC falls: first 20 logos are founder-led and expensive. From 2028 the motion shifts to partner-led — technopark associations, EIT HEI consortia, and ministry frameworks sell one-to-many.

5. Competitive Edge

The landscape splits four ways — and nothing spans it

Category	Examples	Price	What they can't do
Business simulations	Capsim, Cesim, Interpretive, Simformer, HBP	\$11.50–\$85/student	No video courses, no jury scoring of submitted work, no tenancy
Hackathon/judging	Devpost, Award Force, YouNoodle, TAIKAI, ScoreJudge	\$999–\$6,500/yr per program; free tiers exist	Start at submission. No idea what the participant learned. Not per-seat
Accelerator ops	F6S, AcceleratorApp, Startup Space, Optimy	~\$200+/mo to \$50/user/mo	CRM and workflow. No exams, no simulations, no gamification
Institutional LMS	Moodle, Canvas, Blackboard, 360Learning	\$2.24–\$96/user/yr	No multi-judge weighted panels, no team formation, no simulation engine, single-tenant per institution

Verified white space

Public research across 30+ vendors found **no single product** that combines video course progress + server-side graded exams + a simulation engine + weighted-criteria jury scoring + a coin/badge economy, under white-label multi-tenancy, sold per seat to universities, technoparks and government agencies.

Closest partial overlaps and their gaps:

- **HackerEarth** — hackathons + assessments + learning paths, but recruiter-owned, code-scored, no jury panels for business plans, no institutional tenancy.
- **Simformer** — simulations + inter-university championships, but competition means sim ranking, not human jury scoring of submissions; no video delivery.
- **AcceleratorApp** — program ops + a light LMS, but no simulations, no jury scoring, no gamification, priced per org.
- **Award Force** — the best jury mechanics on the market, and nothing else. Zero learners.

The five defensible advantages

1. **One participant record across the whole journey.** A jury score sits next to the exam result and the lessons completed. No competitor owns both sides of that boundary — the sim vendors export to the LMS via LTI, the judging vendors never see the learning.
2. **Auditable judging.** Weighted criteria, per-judge attribution, permissioned PDF access, scheduled reveal, anonymous feedback returned to teams. This survives a contested result; a spreadsheet does not.
3. **Multi-tenancy enforced in code, not policy.** `tenantId` on every core model, PostgreSQL RLS, RBAC matrix with permission removals locked by tests. Sells to a ministry that must guarantee institutional separation.
4. **Buyer-set coverage.** Sim vendors sell to business-school faculty; hackathon tools to corporate devrel; accelerator software to VCs. One product across universities + technoparks + accelerators + agencies is a distribution advantage, not a feature list.
5. **Language and region.** EN/TR/AZ trilingual UI at the data-model level. No competitor found ships Turkish and Azerbaijani together — and no all-in-one regional competitor was found at all.

Honest counter-argument: every individual module is commoditised. Jury scoring is free at ScoreJudge, LMS is free at Moodle, simulations start at \$20/student. The moat is not any one module — it is integration, tenancy

and the switching cost of a multi-year participant record. That moat has to be built through customer count, not code.

6. Roadmap

Product — closing the gaps

Quarter	Milestone	Why it matters commercially
Q4 2026	Live deployment: Terraform apply, secrets, DNS, WAF, monitoring. Payment providers tested with live keys. Email templates localised TR/EN.	Cannot sell what is not deployed. Blocks every paid contract.
Q1 2027	Simulation gameplay UI — interactive decision loop on the existing <code>Simulation / SimulationTask</code> model.	The single largest functional gap; the module competitors charge \$30–\$50/student for.
Q1 2027	Super-admin panels off mock data (billing, content, support, system).	Required before any reseller or agency runs its own tenants.
Q2 2027	AI tool pack live — mentor, pitch coach, jury assistant, auto-evaluation on the existing <code>/ai/chat</code> endpoint.	Highest-margin add-on; the main 2027 pricing uplift.
Q2 2027	PDF certificate generation + S3 pipeline.	Blocks accreditation-sensitive buyers.
Q3 2027	GDPR/KVKK: DSAR export and deletion endpoints.	Hard gate for EU institutions and any public tender.
Q4 2027	Analytics: tenant impact dashboards, cohort cohort-over-cohort comparison, exportable program reports.	The artefact a technopark shows its ministry. Renewal driver.
2028	Public API + LTI 1.3, so BizSim plugs into Canvas/Moodle instead of fighting them.	Removes the "we already have an LMS" objection outright.
2028–29	Simulation authoring for tenants; marketplace for shared program templates.	Network effect and the first non-linear moat.

Commercial milestones

Period	Target	Motion
Q4 2026	5–7 paying institutions, \$49K ARR	Founder-led. Turkey technoparks + Azerbaijan HEIs. Paid pilots, not free ones.
2027	35 institutions, \$327K ARR	First 2 sales hires. Apply to EIT HEI Initiative and Horizon EIE calls as a consortium technology partner.
H1 2028	Series A (~\$3M)	Raised on: NRR >110%, CAC payback <12 mo, 100-institution pipeline.
2028	100 institutions, \$1.1M ARR	Partner-led: technopark associations, ministry frameworks, EU consortium projects.
2029	215 institutions, \$2.69M ARR	EU + Gulf expansion. Enterprise/agency tier becomes the ACV driver.
2030	374 institutions, \$5.28M ARR, EBITDA positive	Self-funding.

Use of funds — \$750K over 24 months

Allocation	%	\$	Buys
Engineering & product	45%	\$337K	5 FTE: simulation gameplay, AI pack, LTI, certificates, DSAR
Sales & partnerships	24%	\$180K	2 FTE + travel; technopark/EU consortium channel
Marketing & program ops	12%	\$90K	Content, conferences, pilot delivery
Infrastructure & compliance	9%	\$68K	AWS, pentest, KVKK/GDPR legal, SOC 2 readiness
G&A & buffer	10%	\$75K	Entity, accounting, contingency

Key risks

Risk	Mitigation
Long public-sector sales cycles (9-24 mo) consume runway before revenue	Lead with paid pilots at department budget level (<\$25K, below RFP threshold) rather than campus-wide deals
EdTech funding at a decade low — Series A may not be there in 2028	Model holds 2027 burn at \$497K; the 2028 plan is throttleable to reach breakeven on seed + revenue if the round slips
Modules are individually commoditised	Compete on integration and the participant record, never on any single feature. Ship LTI so the LMS is a channel, not a rival
Concentration in Turkey/Azerbaijan	EN-first product from day one; EU consortium funding is the planned second geography, not an afterthought
Founder-dependent sales	First two 2027 hires are commercial, not engineering. CAC is modelled to rise before it falls — the plan pays for that learning
Three modules still incomplete	All three are on the funded roadmap with data models already in place; none requires architectural change

Sources

Market sizing: [UNESCO — 264M higher education students](#) · [MarketsandMarkets — Higher Education LMS](#) · [The Business Research Company — Simulation Learning](#) · [MarketsandMarkets — Game-based Learning](#) · [Business Research Insights — Hackathon Management Software](#) · [IAU/UNESCO WHED](#) · [IASP](#) · [InBIA](#) · [HolonIQ — 2025 Global Education Outlook](#)

Beachhead: [YÖK Higher Education Statistics 2025-26](#) · [ASO technopark analysis, April 2026](#) · [Azerbaijan Ministry of Science and Education](#) · [IDDA](#)

Funding environment: [EIT — €70M HEI call](#) · [European Innovation Ecosystems WP 2026-27](#)

Competitors & pricing: [Harvard Business Publishing price list](#) · [Interpretive Simulations](#) · [Simformer](#) · [Award Force pricing](#) · [YouNoodle pricing](#) · [AcceleratorApp LMS](#) · [Moodle pricing](#) · [360Learning pricing](#) · [ScoreJudge](#)

Benchmarks: [First Page Sage — CAC by industry](#) · [Unbuilt Lab — SaaS CAC benchmarks](#) · [Optifai — NRR benchmarks](#) · [GrowthSpree — EdTech GTM 2026](#)